CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 17

Bexley *Applegate*

OWNER OF THE APPLEGATE CIDER PRESS



"You pour every cup of cider at the ball. You remember every cup."

FOR BEXLEY APPLEGATE'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

JOINS AT 8+ PLAYERS

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A flannel shirt or plaid scarf and an apron. Tuck a ladle or a wooden spoon in your pocket.

Mask: a red paper apple mask with a green leaf at the top.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

- **Before the ball:** read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.
- **Round 1:** the top half of page 3, when the Detective says so.
- **Round 2:** the lower half of page 3, below the cut line.
- **Costume Parade:** strike a pose and stay in character.
- **Round 3:** page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

Print this booklet single-sided, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE BALL

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Before it could be made, Vesper sat down in the window chair of the Lantern Gallery and never woke up. Minutes earlier, guests saw the Lantern Ghost drift past the glass.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

> **If you are not in the game, nothing breaks.** You are an optional character: the case can be solved without you, so play for fun, share freely and enjoy your secret.

BACKGROUND

The museum plan includes a museum café with its own cider supplier. Your biggest customer is about to disappear.

YOUR SECRET

This year's crop failed, so tonight's "Applegate pressed" cider is store-bought juice with your spices. You would hate anyone to know.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

From 8:00 to 9:00 you were at the cider urn in the front hall. At 8:20 you filled Vesper's pumpkin cup yourself. Nobody in a fox mask came to your urn. At 8:00 you had topped up the gallery kettle; anyone in the gallery could pour from it.

YOUR GOALS

- Make sure people know the urn cider was fine.
- Keep the store-bought juice quiet until Round 3.
- Find out who used the gallery kettle.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You filled Vesper's pumpkin cup yourself at 8:20, from the urn in the front hall. Vesper carried it off toward the gallery. Nobody in a fox mask came to your urn all evening. Only Vesper was given a pumpkin cup.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "Did Vesper drink cider at the toast, or save it for later?"

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Did you want a cup of cider tonight? You never came to the urn."

YOUR TASK

> Offer three people a (pretend or real) cup of cider and ask where they were at 8:35.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

There is a second source of hot cider: the little kettle on its warmer in an alcove of the Lantern Gallery, near the Back Stairs end. You topped it up at 8:00. Vesper always leaves the empty pumpkin cup beside that kettle for a refill. A steaming cup at 8:35 must have come from there.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Was the cup steaming when you saw it?"

? Ask **Auden Pryor:** "You were near the gallery. Did you see anyone at the kettle?"

YOUR TASK

> Find out who knew about the gallery kettle.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confess that the cider is store-bought juice this year. Then say the gallery kettle was half empty at 9:15, though Vesper only ever drinks one cup.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Did you ever pour from the gallery kettle?"

? Ask **Briar Fallow:** "Where do you keep your sleep drops, and who knew?"

YOUR TASK

> Persuade the room to toast Vesper with a cup of cider after the reveal.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

11 Darcy Wickliffe · Vesper's younger cousin and heir

12 Perry Lanthorn · Lantern-maker who lights the Lantern Gallery

13 Briar Fallow · Costume maker of Candlewick Hollow

14 Jory Greaves · Pumpkin farmer and three-time carving champion

15 Hadley Cresswell · Editor of the Hollow Gazette

16 Auden Pryor (OPT.) · Town historian and keeper of the Lantern Ghost legend

17 Bexley Applegate (OPT.) · Owner of the Applegate cider press

18 Corin Thimble (OPT.) · Fiddler and leader of the ball's band

19 Larkin Hearthstone (OPT.) · Baker of the Candlewick pumpkin pies

20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade